The Techniques Worth Using

Ten NLP techniques to get disgustingly good at finance interviews, from the first prep session to the final round.

PREP

1. **Anchoring**

   Recall a moment you felt sharp and in control, replay it vividly, and at its peak press your thumb and index finger together. Repeat until the gesture reliably brings the feeling back, then use it outside the door before every interview.

IN THE ROOM

2. **Mirroring**

   Subtly match the interviewer's pace, volume, and energy. If an MD talks fast and clipped, tighten your answers; if a VP is relaxed, ease up. Mirror tempo and tone, not gestures, so it reads as chemistry rather than imitation.

IN THE ROOM

3. **Rapport**

   Bankers hire people they'd want next to them at 2 a.m. on a live deal. Find common ground early, like their group, a recent transaction, or a shared school, listen more than you pitch, and let the fit questions feel like a conversation instead of a test.

ANSWERING

4. **Reframing**

   Change the frame of a question to one that works for you. "What's your weakness?" becomes a skill you're actively building. "Walk me through a DCF" becomes a story about valuing a real business, not a memorized checklist. A missed technical becomes a chance to show how you reason.

ANSWERING

5. **Chunking**

   Move between big picture and detail on command. Chunk up to the why (why the deal made sense for the buyer) and chunk down to the how (what happens to EPS). Lead with the headline, then go one level deeper only when the interviewer pulls you there.

PREP

6. **Modeling**

   In NLP, modeling means studying people who already get the result you want and copying how they think. Ask analysts who landed offers how they structured their answers, prepped technicals, and ran networking calls, then rebuild your own process around theirs.

PREP

7. **Future pace**

   Mentally step into the moment you'll need a skill before it arrives: the interviewer asking about a deal you followed, the curveball question, the phone ringing with the offer. Walking through it ahead of time makes the real moment feel familiar instead of new.

IN THE ROOM

8. **Pace and lead**

   First meet the interviewer where they are by acknowledging their question and their framing, then steer toward your strengths: "Great question, that actually came up during my internship when…" Validate first, redirect second, and your best material ends up on the table.

PREP

9. **Mind reps**

   Run the full superday in your head before you live it: walking in, the handshake, "walk me through your resume," the technical round, the brain teaser. Mental rehearsal is standard practice in sports psychology, and the same reps make answers come out smoother under pressure.

IN BETWEEN

10. **State reset**

    Superdays stack interviews back to back, and each interviewer scores you fresh. After every round, take a few slow breaths, let the last conversation go, good or bad, and fire your anchor before the next door opens.

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